

Haligric Research Integration Series

LITHUANIAN SACRED TRADITIONS

A COMPLETE DEEP DIVE

The Last Pagan Country in Europe -- Perkūnas, Romuva, and the Living Baltic Flame

The sacred fire burned at Romuva until 1387.

The oak grove remembered what Europe had forgotten.

The last country in Europe to be Christianized is now among the first to reclaim what was taken.

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Introduction -- The Last Pagan Country in Europe

Lithuania was officially Christianized in 1387 -- when Grand Duke Jogaila converted to Christianity as a condition of his marriage to the Polish queen Jadwiga and the formation of the Polish-Lithuanian union. This date is extraordinary in European context: 1387 is nearly 400 years after Poland (966), nearly 400 years after Russia (988), nearly 200 years after Lithuania's Baltic neighbor Latvia (late 12th century). While the rest of medieval Europe was debating scholastic theology, building Gothic cathedrals, and launching crusades, the Lithuanian sacred oak groves at Romuva still burned with their eternal sacred fire.

This late Christianization means that the Lithuanian sacred tradition has the most complete available documentation of pre-Christian European sacred practice in the medieval period -- observed and recorded by the chroniclers of the Teutonic Knights (who spent two centuries attempting to convert Lithuania by force before the political conversion of 1387), by Polish historians who accompanied the conversion, and by the Lithuanian folk tradition that maintained pre-Christian elements long after official Christianization. They were trying to destroy what they documented, but the documentation survived.

The Baltic Language Family

Lithuanian belongs to the Baltic branch of the Indo-European language family -- the most archaic surviving Indo-European language, preserving grammatical features and vocabulary that have disappeared from every other modern Indo-European language. Linguists studying Proto-Indo-European find Lithuanian extraordinarily valuable because it is closer to the original than Sanskrit, Greek, or Latin. This linguistic archaism corresponds to an equally archaic sacred tradition -- the Lithuanian sacred world is a window into pre-Bronze Age Indo-European religion.

Lithuanian Cosmology -- The Three Worlds and the World Tree

Lithuanian sacred cosmology organizes the universe into three vertically stacked realms -- the underworld, the middle world of the living, and the heavens -- unified by a single connecting structure: the Pasaulio Medis, the World Tree, most often imagined as a great oak. Its roots reach into the underworld, its trunk stands in the world of the living, and its branches extend into the heavens, making the tree simultaneously a map of the cosmos and the physical axis that holds the three realms together in continuous relationship rather than as separated, unreachable domains.

This three-part structure explains why the oak held such comprehensive sacred weight throughout Lithuanian tradition -- the tree of Perkūnas and the tree of Romuva's eternal fire are not two unrelated sacred symbols but two expressions of the same underlying cosmological image: a living thing whose roots, trunk, and branches physically embody the same three worlds every ceremony in this document ultimately addresses. Household and village life continued this vertical logic in miniature -- a home's threshold, hearth, and roof were understood as a household's own small underworld-boundary, middle-world-center, and connection upward, making the World Tree less a distant myth than a pattern repeated at every scale of Lithuanian sacred life.

HALIGRIC LENS: The three-realm cosmos connected by a World Tree is one of the most widely distributed sacred cosmological structures in the world -- found in Finnish, Norse, Siberian, Slavic, and now Lithuanian traditions. Its presence across such diverse and geographically separated cultures is not coincidence; it is evidence of either a shared Proto-Indo-European inheritance or a universal recognition of the structure of consciousness itself: below (the roots, the unconscious, the ancestral), middle (the trunk, the living present), above (the branches, the divine, the aspired-toward).

Dievas -- The Sky God, the Supreme Being

Dievas is the supreme sky god of Lithuanian tradition, the creator of the universe, and the ruler over the whole company of lesser gods -- etymologically the same word as the Latin deus and the Greek Zeus, evidence, alongside Perkūnas's own cognates, of just how deep and how directly this tradition preserves the oldest layer of Indo-European sacred belief. Where Perkūnas is loud, active, and immediately present in every thunderstorm, Dievas is comparatively distant and settled: imagined as living on a farmstead in the sky, an old, dignified householder who presides over prosperity, light, and the moral order the whole cosmos depends on.

A recurring and distinctive figure in Lithuanian folklore is Dievas Senelis ("Old Man God") -- an epithet in which Dievas takes the form of an elderly traveling beggar, walking the roads in disguise specifically to test human hospitality and generosity toward strangers. The tradition holds that any beggar encountered on the road might, in fact, be Dievas himself, giving the ordinary obligation of hospitality genuine sacred weight. Together with the goddess Laima described in the next section, Dievas shares responsibility for world order and human destiny -- Lithuanian folk song describes him riding to a sky wedding with the sun goddess Saulė as his bride, treating the gods as a genuine sky-household rather than remote, abstract powers.

Perkūnas -- The Thunder God and the Eternal Conflict with Velnias

Perkūnas (from a Baltic root cognate with the Slavic Perun, the Norse Thor's root, the Hindu Parjanya, the Finnish Ukko, and the Latin Quercus -- oak) is the most active and most immediately present sacred being in Lithuanian daily and ceremonial life -- the god of thunder, of the sacred oak, of fire, of war, and of the specific sacred justice that distinguishes the civilized world from the chaos that threatens it.

Domain

Thunder and lightning (his most immediate manifestation), the sacred oak (the tree most frequently struck by lightning, understood as Perkūnas's favorite residence), fire (sacred fire in all its forms), the sky and rain, justice and the sacred order, war and masculine sacred power.

The Eternal Conflict with Velnias

Perkūnas and Velnias (the Lithuanian underworld deity, cattle god, and lord of magic -- cognate with the Slavic Veles) are locked in an eternal conflict that appears across all Baltic and Slavic sacred traditions. Velnias steals from Perkūnas's domain (cattle, treasure, a sacred being), retreats to the underworld or hides in specific features of the landscape, and Perkūnas pursues with lightning. Every storm is this pursuit. Rain is the liberation of what Velnias had imprisoned. The world requires both -- the sky above and the underworld below -- and neither wins permanently.

The Cognate Across Indo-European Traditions

The Slavic Perun, the Norse Thor, the Finnish Ukko, the Vedic Indra, the Germanic Donar, the Basque Urtzi/Ortzi, the Lithuanian Perkūnas -- all are expressions of the same Proto-Indo-European thunder deity whose name comes from a root meaning "oak" or "to strike." The Lithuanian preservation of this deity in his most archaic form makes Perkūnas one of the most important available windows into the original Indo-European sacred tradition.

HALIGRIC LENS: The Perkūnas-Velnias conflict is the Baltic and Slavic version of the universal sacred battle between sky and underworld -- the above and the below, light and darkness, order and chaos -- that appears in every tradition in this library in some form.

What distinguishes the Lithuanian version is its theological maturity: neither Perkūnas nor Velnias wins permanently. The world requires both. The storm IS the sacred encounter between them, not a sign of one's victory over the other. This is a cosmological framework that can hold the full complexity of existence without needing to declare one dimension of it evil.

Laima, Žemyna, and the Wider Lithuanian Pantheon

Laima -- Goddess of Fate

Laima ("luck" or "happiness") pronounces every person's destiny at the moment of their birth, deciding -- irrevocably, even beyond her own power to later change -- the shape a life will take. She is especially revered as the protector of pregnant women and the presiding spirit of childbirth itself. In some tellings she appears not as one goddess but as three sisters or three aspects of a single fate-power, each governing a different stage of life, with clear parallels to the Greek Moirai or Norse Norns. Related figures include Dalia (another fate-power) and Giltinė (goddess of death, sometimes described as Laima's own sister -- fate and mortality understood as close kin rather than opposites).

Žemyna -- The Earth Mother

Žemyna is the deified earth itself -- goddess of soil, growth, and the harvest, and by wide agreement the most beloved deity in agrarian Lithuanian life. Farmers kissed the ground at dawn and dusk and poured libations of beer and bread to her before plowing, planting, or burying the dead, since everything that grows and everything that eventually returns to the ground was understood as passing through her domain. In Lithuanian tradition Žemyna is Perkūnas's wife, and their union is renewed each spring as an expression of the land's own returning fertility -- a sacred marriage enacted, in effect, by the season itself.

The Wider Pantheon

Beyond Dievas, Perkūnas, Laima, and Žemyna, Lithuanian tradition recognizes an extensive company of lesser gods and spirits: Saulė, the beloved sun goddess, imagined riding her chariot across the sky; Mėnuo, the moon; Gabija, spirit of the sacred hearth fire, treated as a living household guest fed with bread and salt and never insulted, whose neglect was believed to invite ruin on the whole family; Medeina, ruler of forests, trees, and wild animals, her sacred creature the hare; and Milda, goddess of love and courtship, associated with love freely chosen rather than the domestic bond of marriage. This dense population of household- and domain-specific spirits reflects a broader Lithuanian pattern in which no significant part of daily life -- the hearth, the forest, the field, the act of falling in love -- lacked its own specific sacred guardian.

The Sacred Feminine -- Laima, the Deives, and the Goddess Tradition

The Lithuanian sacred feminine tradition is one of the most extensively documented in the Indo-European world -- a rich cluster of goddess figures, fate beings, and sacred feminine presences that governed the most intimate and most fundamental dimensions of life: birth, fate, love, death, the earth's fertility, and the sacred fire of the household. Understanding this tradition as a unified framework rather than a list of separate deities reveals the coherence of the Lithuanian sacred feminine: these are not unrelated individual goddesses but expressions of a continuous sacred feminine intelligence that operates at every scale of life, from the household hearth to the cosmic fate.

Laima -- already treated in the previous section -- is the central fate goddess, but she does not stand alone. Lithuanian tradition recognizes a cluster of related fate beings (often collectively called Deives Valdytojos -- governing goddesses or mistress deities) who

together govern the complete range of fates action on human life. Dalia is Laimas closest associate -- in some tellings the two are aspects of a single power, in others they are distinct beings who share the work of fate-determination. Where Laima pronounces the overall shape of a life at the moment of birth, Dalia governs the specific distribution of goods and circumstances -- the portion (dalia means "share" or "portion") that each person receives. Dalias domain is the distribution of material fortune, while Laimas is the determination of destiny at the deepest level.

Giltine -- the goddess of death, understood in some tellings as Laimas own sister -- governs the final transition. Her name comes from the same root as gelti, "to sting" -- she is the one who extracts the soul from the body at the moment of death, her presence experienced as the specific chill that precedes dying. Giltine is not evil -- she is necessary. The Lithuanian sacred tradition, unlike many Western traditions, does not demonize death or its goddess. Giltine is the completion of what Laima began, the fate-being who closes what the birth-fate-being opened. The symmetry between Laima (who pronounces fate at birth) and Giltine (who executes fate at death) is the Baltic understanding of life as a sacred arc held between two sacred feminine presences.

Milda is the goddess of love and freedom -- specifically of love freely chosen rather than the love of obligation and family bond (which is Zemynas domain). Milda governs courtship, romantic love, and the specific sacred dimension of the freely given heart. She is associated with doves and with the specific quality of love that cannot be commanded, only received. Her presence in Lithuanian tradition reflects the sophisticated understanding that different dimensions of love and human bonding require different sacred presences: Milda for eros and free choice, Zemyna for the earth-bond and family love, Laima for the fate that brings two people together in the first place.

Saule -- the Sun Goddess (grammatically feminine in Lithuanian, unlike the masculine Sun of many traditions) -- is one of the most beloved figures in the Lithuanian sacred world. She rides her chariot across the sky, weaving the light that sustains all life, and is associated with the specific golden quality of summer light, with the linden tree (her sacred tree), and with amber (fossilized tree resin that the Baltic peoples gathered from the shores of the Baltic Sea and traded across Europe). Saules daily journey is understood as her weaving -- the light of each day is her specific sacred craft. At the summer solstice (Jonines/Rasos), the fires lit on hilltops are lit in Saules honor at the exact moment of her greatest power. The specific relationship between Saule and Menuo (the Moon) -- husband and wife in some versions, separated and grieving in others -- is one of the richest mythological cycles in the Lithuanian tradition, encoded in thousands of dainas (sacred folk songs) that use the relationship between sun and moon to explore the full range of human love, loss, and longing.

Ragana -- the witch, the shapeshifter -- is the sacred feminines most complex and most contested figure. In folk tradition, the ragana is a powerful woman who can transform, who knows herbs and poisons, who operates at the edge of the human community and at the boundary between ordinary and sacred reality. Christian-era reinterpretation demonized the ragana as a figure of malevolence, but in the older stratum of tradition she appears as a figure of genuine sacred power -- the woman who knows, who crosses the boundary, who is feared precisely because she cannot be controlled by ordinary social structures. Contemporary Lithuanian neopagan practice (within Romuva) has worked to recover the pre-Christian understanding of the ragana as a sacred specialist rather than a figure of evil.

HALIGRIC LENS: The Lithuanian sacred feminine tradition is the most complete available Indo-European demonstration that the Indo-European sacred world before the patriarchal Bronze Age overlay was a world of profound feminine sacred presence. Saule driving her chariot, Laima pronouncing fate, Zemyna receiving the libation, Milda holding the freely given heart, Giltine waiting at the threshold -- these are not minor peripheral figures. They govern birth, fate, death, earth, fire, love, and the light that

makes all life possible. The Haligric practitioner who encounters this tradition recognizes in it the same divine feminine intelligence that Hildegard called Viriditas, that the Guarani tradition honors as the grandmother figures who carried the sacred word, that the Yoruba tradition names as the Orisha of femininity and earth. The name changes. The intelligence that is being named does not.

The Krivis -- Baltic High Priesthood

The Krivis (Krivis Krivaitis, roughly "chief of chiefs") was the high priest of the old Baltic religion -- known primarily from the 16th-century writings of Simon Grunau, who described the Krivis residing at Romuva and commanding reverence comparable, in Grunau's own framing, to that shown a Catholic pope. Because reliable contemporary written sources are scarce, some modern scholars have questioned whether a single unified high priesthood of this kind genuinely existed across all Baltic tribes, or whether the office as described reflects later romantic reconstruction -- a live scholarly debate this document presents honestly rather than resolving.

What is better attested is a local priesthood: the vaidila (priest) and vaidilutė (priestess, plural vaidilutės, tending the eternal fire) served as recognized religious authorities at the community level. A distinctive Baltic tool of local governance, the krivule -- a twisted wooden staff -- was carried by village elders to summon neighbors to common gatherings, recorded as surviving into the 19th century.

The title Krivis was revived in 2002, when Jonas Trinkūnas -- the ethnologist and folklorist who founded the modern Romuva religious movement -- was formally installed as Krivis Krivaitis, taking the name Jaunius ("young one") to symbolize the rebirth of the ancestral faith after Soviet-era suppression. Trinkūnas led Romuva until his death in 2014. His wife Inija Trinkūnienė was chosen as the new Krivė (high priestess) and ordained on 31 May 2015 in Vilnius on Gediminas Hill -- the first woman to hold the role in the long history of the Baltic tradition.

Romuva -- The Sacred Center, Eternal Fire, and the Vaidilutės

Romuva was the primary sacred site of Baltic religion -- a sacred oak grove in Prussia (the western Baltic region, now part of Russia's Kaliningrad Oblast) that served as the religious center of the Baltic peoples, centered on an eternal sacred fire that burned continuously at the base of a great oak. The Romuva site was centered on a specific great oak tree of extraordinary age and size -- the most sacred tree in the Baltic world. Three sacred images were set in the oak's branches: Perkūnas (in the upper branches, facing east), Peckols (a death deity, in the lower portion), and Potrimpos (a fertility deity, to the side). The eternal fire burned at the oak's base.

The Eternal Fire (Ugnis)

The sacred fire at Romuva was maintained without interruption -- understood as the specific presence of the divine in the material world, the connection point between the human community and the sacred realm above. Its specific sacred parallel with the Vestal fire of Rome is striking: both were eternal flames maintained by consecrated female specialists, both were understood as the specific condition on which the community's survival depended, and both were extinguished definitively with the Christianization of the territory they served. The Vestal fire was extinguished in 391 CE when Emperor Theodosius I ordered the closure of all pagan temples. The Romuva fire burned nearly a thousand years longer.

The Vaidilutės

The Lithuanian equivalent of the Roman Vestal Virgins -- consecrated women whose specific sacred obligation was the maintenance of the eternal fire. Like the Vestals, their purity (understood as virginity) was the specific sacred condition on which the fire's efficacy

depended. Like the Vestals, violation of their vow was punished with burial alive. The parallel is too close to be coincidental -- it reflects a common Indo-European sacred technology for the maintenance of community fire, preserved in Rome until 391 CE and in Lithuania until 1387.

The Eternal Fire Ceremony -- Step-by-Step

Step 1 -- The Vaidilutė's Vigil: The vaidilutė assigned to the current watch tends the fire with specific protocols -- adding sacred oak wood (Perkūnas's tree), maintaining the specific flame characteristics, speaking specific prayers.

Step 2 -- The Morning Address: At the rise of each day, the sacred fire is formally addressed -- prayers to Perkūnas and to Dievas spoken at the fire, acknowledging the new day's beginning.

Step 3 -- The Krivis's Procession (Major Ceremony): On sacred festival days, the Krivis leads a formal procession to the Romuva sacred site -- the entire priestly establishment assembled.

Step 4 -- The Sacrifice at the Fire: Specific animals are sacrificed at the eternal fire -- the most sacred offering directed through the fire to the divine world.

Step 5 -- The Augury (Omen Reading): The Krivis reads specific sacred signs -- the fire's behavior, the behavior of sacred animals, specific natural phenomena -- interpreting the divine world's communications for the assembled community.

Step 6 -- The Communal Feast: The sacred animals are prepared and the community feasts -- the divine world's portion offered through the fire, the human community receiving the rest as the divine gift of abundance.

Step 7 -- The Closing Prayers: Specific closing prayers formally conclude the ceremony -- thanking Perkūnas, Dievas, and the other sacred beings, and returning the sacred space to its ordinary maintenance state.

Užgavėnės -- Driving Away Winter, Step-by-Step

Užgavėnės (from "užgauti" -- to push away, to drive away: "the driving away") is the Lithuanian ceremony of winter expulsion -- a specific pre-Christian ceremony that survived official Christianization and is still practiced in Lithuania today, typically on the Tuesday or Saturday before Ash Wednesday. The expulsion of winter through the ritual confrontation between winter (Morė -- the winter figure) and spring is one of the most universally distributed pre-Christian European seasonal ceremonies, found in Lithuanian, Latvian, Slavic, Germanic, and Basque traditions in different forms.

Step 1 -- The Construction: The Morė effigy -- a large female figure representing winter, cold, death, and the end of the dark season -- is constructed by the community from straw, rags, and winter materials.

Step 2 -- The Pancakes (Blynai): Užgavėnės is specifically associated with pancakes -- foods representing the spring's return and the return of abundance. The round, golden pancake represents the returning sun. Eating pancakes on Užgavėnės is still a widespread Lithuanian practice.

Step 3 -- The Battle: A ritual battle is staged between winter (Bėdas) and spring -- a theatrical confrontation that always ends with spring's victory. The battle is simultaneously ceremony and declaration.

Step 4 -- The Burning: The Morė effigy is burned -- the fire destroying winter and releasing spring. "Winter has been burned! Spring is coming!" is the traditional declaration.

Step 5 -- The Noisy Drive-Away: The community makes as much noise as possible -- banging pots, ringing bells, shouting -- to drive the spirits of winter and disease away from the village.

Step 6 -- The Spring Welcome: Specific spring greetings and songs are performed -- the community declaring that spring has arrived and is welcome.

This ceremony is still practiced in Lithuania and by Lithuanian diaspora communities worldwide.

Joninès / Rasos -- The Sacred Midsummer Night, Step-by-Step

Joninès (Midsummer / Saint John's Night) -- the summer solstice celebration, now aligned with Saint John's Day in the Christian calendar overlay. The Lithuanian Joninès/Rasos (Rasos means "dew") has its own specific sacred emphases -- particularly the sacred dew gathered on Midsummer Eve, the specific flower wreath divination, and the search for the sacred fern flower in the forest.

Step 1 -- The Sacred Fires: Large bonfires on hilltops -- the hilltop fire visible across the countryside, the community gathering around the sacred flames.

Step 2 -- The Jumping: Couples jump the fire together -- the sacred purification and the love divination.

Step 3 -- The Dew Ceremony: Before dawn on Midsummer Eve, women go to the meadows and collect the specific sacred dew -- dew gathered on Midsummer Eve is understood as carrying specific sacred healing and beauty properties, used for washing the face, healing applications, and specific sacred preparations.

Step 4 -- The Flower Wreaths: Wreaths of specific sacred herbs (rue -- rūta -- the national sacred plant of Lithuania, associated with purity and fate) are made and set on the water. The direction they float carries divinatory meaning.

Step 5 -- The Fern Flower Search: Young people go into the forest to search for the legendary fern flower. The forest at Midsummer is the specific location where the boundary between the human world and the sacred world is thinnest.

Step 6 -- The Dawn: The ceremony closes at dawn -- the sunrise greeted collectively as the sacred night's completion.

Vèlinès -- The Festival of the Dead, Step-by-Step

Vèlinès (from vèlè, "soul of the dead"; also called Ilgès in older sources) is the Lithuanian festival honoring ancestors, observed at the start of November and understood as the time when the souls of the dead return to visit the homes and families they once belonged to. The festival's name and underlying logic long predate its present alignment with the Catholic All Souls' Day, reflecting a genuinely pre-Christian layer of practice that Christianization absorbed rather than eliminated.

Setting the Table for the Dead: Families historically prepared a supper of several distinct dishes -- accounts describe as many as twelve dark or somber foods -- setting the table with doors and windows left open so the returning souls could enter freely. A place was left at a corner of the table with no living person seated there, food and drink placed specifically for the visiting dead, accompanied by the words "this is for you, dear souls."

The Candle Rite: The oldest person present takes a candle, circles it around their own head, then three times around the food, before lighting it and setting it on the table -- marking the meal as shared between living and dead. The meal itself was eaten in silence, out of respect for the unseen guests believed to be present.

The Gravesite Visit and Almsgiving: Graves are visited, decorated with flowers, and lit with candles -- believed to light the way for souls thought to wander in darkness. Special bread rolls were baked and given to beggars, each roll assigned the name of a specific deceased family member and given with a request that the recipient pray for that person's soul -- turning an act of charity into a direct, practical continuation of the family's relationship with its dead.

Together with Užgavėnės and Joninės, Vėlinės completes the three great calendar festivals that carried Lithuania's pre-Christian sacred year forward through centuries of official Christianization, preserved in folk custom even after the formal religious structures around them had disappeared.

Contemporary Lithuanian Sacred Life -- Romuva and State Recognition

The Romuva movement -- the organized revival of Lithuanian Baltic religion -- has been one of the most significant spiritual and cultural phenomena in post-Soviet Lithuania. Founded in the late Soviet period by Jonas Trinkūnas, an ethnologist who spent decades collecting and preserving Lithuanian folk tradition, Romuva drew on the living folk record of dainas (sacred folk songs), seasonal ceremonies, and household sacred practices to reconstruct and revive pre-Christian Lithuanian religion not as museum recreation but as living practice.

After years of effort and a landmark legal battle, Romuva achieved state recognition in Lithuania in December 2024, when the Seimas (Lithuanian parliament) voted to formally recognize the community as a religious organization -- following a June 2021 European Court of Human Rights ruling that had found the Seimas did not remain "neutral and impartial" in rejecting a previous petition. The current Krivė (high priestess) is Inija Trinkūnienė, Jonas Trinkūnas's wife, who was ordained in 2015 as the first woman to hold the role in the Baltic tradition's long history. Over 5,000 Lithuanians now identify with Romuva, with congregations also existing in Australia, Canada, the United States, and England.

The Užgavėnės ceremony is still celebrated every year across Lithuania. The Joninės fires still burn on the hilltops. The sacred plant rūta (rue) still marks Lithuanian sacred identity in folk tradition. Perkūnas is still invoked by those who know his name. The last country in Europe to be Christianized is now, appropriately, among the first in Europe to receive state recognition for the tradition that Christianity replaced.

The Haligrity Lens -- The Sacred Fire That Outlasted Rome

Lithuania's sacred tradition offers Haligrity the most temporally recent available window into pre-Christian European religion -- a tradition that was still being actively practiced while the rest of Europe had been nominally Christian for centuries, whose documentation by those who came to destroy it creates an involuntary sacred record of extraordinary value.

The Vestal Virgins of Rome kept their sacred fire for a thousand years. The Vaidilutės of Romuva kept theirs until 1387. Both flames were extinguished by the same process -- not by better theology but by political power. The fire at Romuva burned while Thomas Aquinas wrote and Dante walked his imaginary Inferno and the Crusaders fought over Jerusalem. The lightning still hit the oak trees in the Lithuanian forest and Perkūnas was still being invoked. The sacred world does not require institutional support to be real. It requires people who remember. Lithuania remembered longer than anyone else in Europe.

The Romuva movement's achievement of state recognition in 2024 -- after winning a European Court of Human Rights case over the Lithuanian parliament's refusal -- is the Haligrity practitioner's evidence that what was suppressed by force for 637 years was not destroyed. It simply waited. The oak still stands. The fire was relit. Grand Rising.